

Revival, Surrender, Zeal

Statistics show that 50% to 80% of students who enter university as professing Christians leave university with little to no faith. Yet, those who find or reaffirm their faith in university often go on to live lives of continual pursuit of Jesus and spiritual flourishing. As a student-led Christian fellowship on one of the largest and most secular campuses globally, we face a significant challenge and an extraordinary opportunity to build authentic, transformative faith. This is the role of CCF in the kingdom of heaven, taking advantage of our position to boldly transform believers and non-believers alike.

Revival- Psalm 85:6; Isaiah 43:18-19; 2 Corinthians 5:17

For those who have powerfully and personally encountered Jesus, often at retreats, conferences, summer camps, bible schools, worship nights, life's lowest lows and highest highs, how can we continue living as we did before? When you radically encounter a radical Saviour who radically lived, loved, and died for you, the natural response should be radical. These transformative experiences should set the baseline for the continual pursuit of a deeper, more intimate Union with Christ.

Fortunately, God is already beginning to refocus our eyes. Events like Outreach Night and UofTogether's Night of Revival are precisely what CCF needs to embrace fully and learn to be swept away by. These events only scratch the surface of what the Lord has in store for us, but it's up to us to lean in and obey His guiding hand. By examining Jesus' life and teachings, we clearly see that being a follower of God often requires boldness and courage. An outward looking mindset that embraces uncomfortable situations while maintaining humility and purity.

Surrender- Acts 17: 24-31; 2 Corinthians 12:9; Romans 8: 24-27

One weakness I've noticed in CCF is an unhealthy attachment to comfort and tradition. Authentic faithfulness requires us to be open and adaptable to God's fresh wind. While traditions should be celebrated when they arise naturally, we shouldn't aim to replicate them artificially. Every iteration of CCF brings people with unique gifts, passions, and convictions. Allowing traditions to rise authentically and fade naturally opens doors for God's creativity to flourish anew. By embracing full surrender to God, my hope is that next year brings fresh experiences and opportunities for more genuine encounters with Jesus. I am certain that not everything will go as planned, but I am also certain that God will meet us halfway and supplement our inadequacies.

Additionally, we need to recognize our limitations as a horizontally-led fellowship of young adults. While I appreciate our effort to intellectually decipher scripture, we must acknowledge our limited expertise. Rather than striving to answer complex theological truths that require advanced biblical training, we can focus on sharing personal experiences of God's work and practical applications of scripture, something we are all qualified to do. Openly sharing testimonies and discussing simple and practical topics relevant to us as students (career,

relationships, mental health, finances, and the Gospel message) can equally enhance our spiritual growth.

Zeal- 2 Timothy 1:7, Colossians 2:6-23

God is clearly raising a new generation passionate about pursuing Him and eager to serve as conduits of His will. Rather than wrestling God for control, let's joyfully embrace this spirit of revival and actively create opportunities for God to glorify Himself through our fellowship.

Practically, my vision involves initiating various new activities designed to foster genuine encounters with Jesus. Examples include campus crusades, serving the homeless, weekly sharing of testimonies, more collabs, and attempting new prayer and worship styles.

Ultimately, my expansive vision boils down to providing ample opportunities for our members to genuinely encounter Jesus, become transformed, and zealously and holistically grow as believers. Rather than focusing solely on fixing a few isolated issues, I aim to return to the basics. Fostering a central passion for Jesus from which all else naturally flows.